BPM, Governance, and POC $\rightarrow$ MVP $\rightarrow$ Production

Module 16 — Business AI in Practice · Notebook 52

Prof. Dr. Christoph Weisser

HSBI

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2026-07-22

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Contents

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BPM, Governance, and POC → MVP → Production

└─Contents

Contents

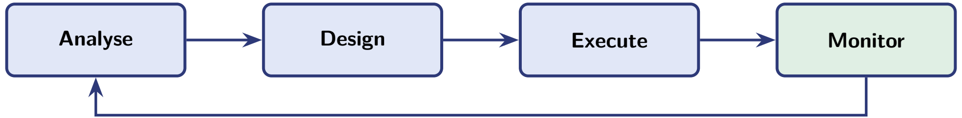
1 BPM
2 Governance
3 POC to Prod
4 Cases
5 Checklist

Outline

Outline

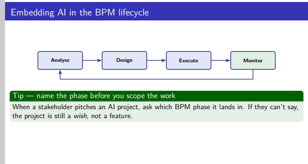
1. BPM
2. Governance
3. POC to Prod
4. Cases
5. Checklist

Embedding AI in the BPM lifecycle



Tip — name the phase before you scope the work

When a stakeholder pitches an AI project, ask which BPM phase it lands in. If they can't say, the project is still a *wish*, not a feature.



∼**8 min.** Point: AI lands *inside* an existing process, never on a blank page.

Walk the loop once, then make it concrete — most AI work sits in **Execute** (the model does a step) or **Monitor** (the model watches for drift). Analyse/Design are where it usually *should* have started.

Ask the room: "Think of an AI feature you've seen demoed. Which phase was it in?" Expect Execute almost every time — that's the lesson: teams automate a step before understanding the process.

Misconception to pre-empt: that the loop runs once. It doesn't — Monitor feeds back into Analyse, which is exactly why deployed models need owners, not just builders.

Outline

Outline
BPM
Governance
POC to Prod
Cases
Checklist

Governance — a RACI for an AI initiative

RACI, extended so the *AI system* is a named actor

Responsible · Accountable · Consulted · Informed.

- The AI is **R** for an *individual* decision — but a human is always **A**. The AI cannot be blamed.
- **Compliance is A** for the provider choice — anything touching customer data has a veto.
- **Rollback is owned by the platform team**: ML decides *whether* to revert; platform can actually *do* it.

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~**10 min.** Point: governance is about naming *who is accountable when the model is wrong* — before it is wrong.

The one line that lands: **the AI can be Responsible, but never Accountable.** A system cannot be fired, sued, or asked to explain itself to a regulator. Accountability always terminates at a human.

Ask the room: "Your model declines a customer's loan. Who does the customer complain to?" Let them argue — the useful answer is that if nobody in the org can name that person, the system isn't ready to ship.

Why rollback is split: the team that can judge whether to revert is rarely the team with production access. If those two aren't wired together in advance, a bad deploy stays live through the argument.

Full RACI table is in Notebook 52 — don't rebuild it on the board.

Outline

Outline

1 BPM
2 Governance
3 POC to Prod
4 Cases
5 Checklist

POC → MVP → Production — three projects, not three phases

POC
Can it do the task at all?
a demo on curated data
audience:
decision-makers

→

MVP
Will users use it?
a few real
users, real work
audience: early adopters

→

Production
the *default* tool
SLOs, on-call,
dashboards
audience: everyone

The most common confusion

Production is *not* "MVP, but more robust." It is MVP *plus all the boring operational work* — monitoring, rollback, cost control, support.

∼12 min — the core slide of the lecture.

Point: these three answer *different questions* and have *different audiences*, so they need different success criteria. A POC judged by production standards always looks like a failure; a production system judged by POC standards always looks finished.

The trap to name explicitly: the demo that works on curated data gets applauded, and someone says "great, ship it Monday." Everything expensive lives in the gap between MVP and Production — and none of it is model work.

Ask the room: "What percentage of a shipped AI project is the model?" Collect guesses, then hold the answer until the next slide, where the invoice case gives it: *about 30 %*.

If the room is engineering-heavy, dwell on "three projects, not three phases" — each transition is a re-scope, not a continuation.

Outline

2026-07-22

BPM, Governance, and POC → MVP → Production

└Cases

└Outline

Three case studies — what real initiatives look like

- **Triage (shipped).** The classifier wasn't the hard part — ticketing integration, queue routing, and the override UI were. The provider shim and monitoring both paid off.
- **Invoice processing (shipped).** The AI was *30 %* of the project; ingestion, ERP integration, and the review UI were the other 70 %. Trust grew from *observation*; a rule layer caught hallucinated invoice numbers.
- **Sales analytics (did not ship).** A solution looking for a problem — never a specific user story. *Discovery is allowed to conclude "don't build it."*

Three case studies — what real initiatives look like

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∼12 min. Point: the pattern across all three is that *the model was never the hard part*.

Now pay off the previous slide's question with the invoice number: the AI was **30 %** of the project; ingestion, ERP integration and the review UI were the other 70 %.

Spend real time on the third case. A project that correctly did *not* ship is a success story, and students almost never hear one. The failure wasn't technical — nobody could name a specific user with a specific task. That is the same test as question 1 and 2 on the next slide.

Ask the room: "Who here has been on a project that should have been stopped and wasn't? What would have had to be true to stop it?" — good discussion if the cohort has industry experience; skip if they're pre-career.

Trust point worth stating: in the invoice case trust grew from *observation* — users watched it be right for weeks before relying on it. You cannot argue people into trusting a model.

Outline

2026-07-22

BPM, Governance, and POC → MVP → Production
└Checklist
└Outline

Outline
BPM
Governance
POC to Prod
Cases
Checklist

A one-page readiness checklist

Ten questions a technical lead uses to say “no” constructively

1. **User** — who *specifically* uses it?
2. **Task** — which task does it absorb? (name it with a verb)
3. **BPM phase** — analyse / design / execute / monitor?
4. **Pattern** $\times$ **stake** — where on the 2$\times$2 from Notebook 49?
5. **Baseline** — how is the task done today, and how long does it take?
6. **Success metric** — what number is measurably different in 8 weeks?
7. **Failure mode** — what does a wrong answer look like, and who notices?
8. **Rollback** — can you switch it off in 5 minutes?
9. **Cost model** — per-call cost, and the implied monthly bill at full scale?
10. **RACI** — who is A for runtime, compliance, and rollback?

Full detail, the RACI table, and the three cases end-to-end are in **Notebook 52**.

A one-page readiness checklist
Ten questions a technical lead uses to say “no” constructively
User — who specifically uses it?
Task — which task does it absorb? (name it with a verb)
BPM phase — analyse / design / execute / monitor?
Pattern × stake — where on the 2×2 from Notebook 49?
Baseline — how is the task done today, and how long does it take?
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RACI — who is A for runtime, compliance, and rollback?
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$\sim$**10 min + close.** Point: this is the slide they should photograph. Frame it as the tool that lets a technical lead say “no” *constructively* — not by refusing, but by asking questions the proposal can’t yet answer.

Don’t read all ten aloud. Pick three and go deep — **5 (baseline)**, **6 (success metric)** and **8 (rollback)** are the ones that kill bad projects fastest. Note that 4 calls back to the 2$\times$2 from Notebook 49, so this is a synthesis, not a new framework.

Best closing exercise if you have 15 minutes: have them apply the list to a real proposal — their own, or the sales-analytics case from the previous slide. It fails at questions 1, 2 and 6, and they’ll find that themselves.

Send them to Notebook 52 for the RACI table and the cases end-to-end; the notebook’s checkpoints mirror this checklist.